WATERCRESS AND EGG YOLK RAVIOLI

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
2	**2 h**

INGREDIENTS

100 g	Pasta Dough — 00 flour
1	Pasta Dough — egg
1	Pasta Dough — egg yolk
1 dash	Pasta Dough — rapeseed oil
1 pinch	Pasta Dough — salt
6 handfuls	Pasta Filling — watercress (leaves picked, stalks reserved)
1	Pasta Filling — onion
1	Pasta Filling — lime, zested
50 g	Pasta Filling — pecorino (or Lord of The Hundreds)
2 tbsp	Pasta Filling — mascarpone
to taste	Pasta Filling — salt and pepper
3	Pasta Filling — egg yolks (large, raw - for filling)
1/2	Celeriac Purée — celeriac, peeled and diced
50 ml	Celeriac Purée — whole milk
25 g	Celeriac Purée — unsalted butter, chilled and diced
to taste	Celeriac Purée — salt
100 g	Sauce — button mushrooms, sliced
1	Sauce — garlic clove, halved
50 g	Sauce — Madeira
125 ml	Sauce — vegetable stock
125 ml	Sauce — double cream
to taste	Sauce — salt and sugar
1	Garnish — Jerusalem artichoke
for frying	Garnish — vegetable oil
1 handful	Garnish — mixed wild mushrooms
3 sprigs	Garnish — tenderstem broccoli
1 dash	Garnish — rapeseed oil
2 knobs	Garnish — butter
to taste	Garnish — salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Make pasta dough: Place flour in food processor with egg and yolk, blend until dough comes together. Tip out, knead 5 minutes until smooth and elastic. Wrap in cling film, rest in fridge at least 30 minutes (up to 24 hours).
2. Prepare filling: Pick watercress leaves, set stalks aside. Reserve few small leaves for garnish, blanch rest in boiling water 30 seconds. Chill quickly in iced water, squeeze out all moisture (use tea towel or muslin). Chop blanched leaves. Finely chop half onion, roughly chop other half.
3. Shape filling: Add finely chopped onion to watercress with mascarpone and lime zest. Finely grate in pecorino, season to taste. Use 8cm round cutter to shape filling into 2 pucks (1.5cm high). Chill in fridge.
4. Make sauce: Add roughly chopped onion, watercress stalks, button mushrooms and garlic to pan with dash oil and season. Cook 5 minutes until softened. Deglaze with Madeira, simmer until reduced by half. Add stock and cream, bring to boil. Remove from heat, cover with clingfilm, leave to infuse 1 hour.
5. Make celeriac purée: Boil or steam celeriac until tender (around 20 minutes). Drain, transfer to blender. Blitz with milk and cold butter, season. Pass through fine sieve into clean pan.
6. Roll pasta: Lightly flour work surface, unwrap dough. Roll until thin enough for machine, then roll through machine twice at widest setting. Continue making setting thinner by 1 each time until lowest setting. Cut into 4 equal 12cm squares.
7. Form ravioli: Place discs of filling on 2 squares. Make small well in each, carefully nestle in egg yolk. Beat remaining yolk, brush around filling. Top with another square, seal carefully around edges - don't leave air bubbles. Use dull side of 9cm round cutter to press around filling, flip and use sharp side to trim. Rest in fridge 20 minutes on semolina-dusted tray.
8. Prepare artichoke crisps: Slice artichokes finely on mandoline. Deep-fry at 140°C until lightly golden, drain on kitchen paper. Season with salt.
9. Strain sauce: After infusing 1 hour, strain through fine sieve into clean pan. Season to taste with salt and sugar.
10. Cook and assemble: Set up large pan salted boiling water and small frying pan over medium heat with rapeseed oil. Cook ravioli 3-4 minutes, add broccoli for last minute. Meanwhile gently reheat celeriac purée and sauce. Add wild mushrooms to frying pan, cook until coloring, add butter and remaining onion. Season.
11. Plate: Drain ravioli, transfer to frying pan with butter and splash pasta water. Start with swipe of celeriac puree. Top with mushrooms, broccoli, artichoke crisps. Add cheese shavings and small watercress leaves. Place ravioli next to

mushrooms. Use hand blender to whip sauce into foam, spoon over ravioli to finish.

NOTES

A large, single raviolo filled with cheese, watercress and a runny egg yolk takes centre stage in this beautiful starter. The creamy celeriac purée is topped with wild mushrooms, broccoli and Jerusalem artichoke crisps, while the foamy watercress and mushroom sauce adds bags of earthy autumnal flavour.
Chef's Tips: The raw egg yolk is the star of this dish - it creates a wonderful rich sauce when the raviolo is cut. The trick is handling the delicate yolk without breaking it. This is an autumn/winter dish perfect for dinner parties.

FILLING
Watercress and Egg Yolk Filling

INGREDIENTS

6 handfuls	Watercress mixture — watercress (leaves picked, stalks reserved)
1	Watercress mixture — onion
1	Watercress mixture — lime, zested
50 g	Watercress mixture — pecorino (or Lord of The Hundreds)
2 tbsp	Watercress mixture — mascarpone
to taste	Watercress mixture — salt and pepper
3	Egg yolk — egg yolks, large and raw

METHOD

1. Pick the watercress leaves and set the stalks aside. Hold back a few small leaves for garnish.
2. Blanch the rest 30 seconds, chill in iced water, then wring out every drop in a tea towel or muslin. Chop the blanched leaves.
3. Finely chop half the onion and roughly chop the other half.
4. Stir 1 tbsp of the finely chopped onion into the watercress with the mascarpone and lime zest. Grate in the pecorino and season.
5. Shape into 2 pucks 1.5 cm high with an 8 cm round cutter, and chill.
6. At assembly, press a small well into each puck and nestle a raw yolk in it.
7. Beat the third yolk and brush it around the filling as the seal.

NOTES

Two sub-components: a shaped watercress puck and a raw yolk that sits inside it. The yolk stays raw and turns into the sauce when the raviolo is cut, so the trick is getting it in without breaking it.
The 3 yolks split 2 inside and 1 beaten for the wash.
Only 1 tbsp of the finely chopped half goes in here. A second tbsp of it is fried with the wild mushrooms at plating, and the roughly chopped half goes to the sauce base, so most of the onion is used outside this file.
The reserved stalks go to the mushroom sauce, outside this file.
Squeezing the watercress properly dry is what keeps the puck holding its shape.

SHAPE
Ravioli

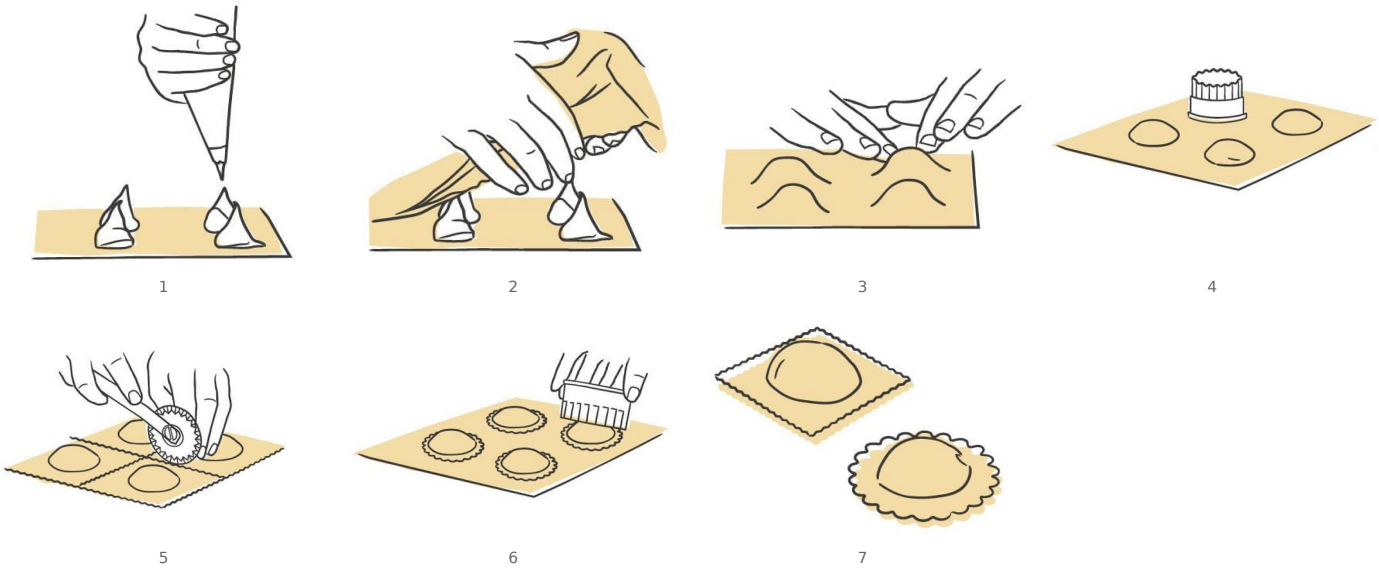
Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.

11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.
Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.